

UNITED NATIONS NATIONS UNIES
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026

Fellowship Award Specification

**Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
Sub -regional Office for Mesoamerica**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Panama City, Panama
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Better Nutrition

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Mr. Adoniram Sanches
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Subregional Coordinator
<u>Name of the Direct Supervisor</u>	Mr. Israel Ríos
<u>Title of the Direct Supervisor:</u>	Nutrition Officer

3. Background information

The Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) is a specialized agency of the United Nations leading international efforts to defeat hunger. Its overarching goal is to achieve food security for all, ensuring that people have regular access to sufficient, high-quality food for active and healthy lives. With 195 Members—194 countries and the European Union—FAO operates in more than 130 countries worldwide.

At the subregional level, FAO works through its Subregional Office for Mesoamerica (SLM) located in Panama City, Panama, which plays a pivotal role in translating this global mandate into concrete actions.

The Subregional Office facilitates coordination with regional institutions and national governments, liaises with FAO Representatives in the subregion, supports the implementation of regional projects, and provides technical assistance through locally adapted rural development approaches.

To deliver on its mandate in Mesoamerica, FAO's organizational structure comprises four technical teams aligned with the Organization's Four Betters: Better Production, Better Nutrition, Better Environment and Better Life. These teams are supported by six additional units that ensure effective logistical and managerial functions: Administration, Procurement, Information Technology, Human Resources, Operations and Communication.

Among these priorities, Better Nutrition is central to eradicating hunger, achieving food security and fighting against malnutrition in all its forms. It promotes access to healthy diets and nutritious foods through five programmatic areas: Healthy diets for all; Nutrition for the most vulnerable; Safe food for all; Reduction of food loss and waste; and Transparent markets. Advancing the transition toward healthy diets and improved food security for the most vulnerable remains a key regional priority.

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, the candidate will perform the following duties:

1. Knowledge Management and Community Engagement
 - Support the systematization of activities, lessons learned and next steps of the Community of Practice on Dietary Guidelines in Latin America and the Caribbean.
 - Contribute to the design of knowledge products and dissemination strategies to strengthen regional collaboration.
2. Technical Writing and Research
 - Draft and co-develop manuscripts for technical reports and external publications on key thematic areas, including School Food and Nutrition, Dietary Guidelines, Food and Nutrition Education (FNE), and food labeling.
 - Ensure alignment with FAO editorial standards and scientific rigor under the guidance of the supervisor.
3. Editorial Process Coordination
 - Assist in coordinating the publication workflow through FAO's Publication Workflow System (PWS), ensuring compliance with editorial policies, metadata accuracy and quality control.
 - Gain practical experience in the UN editorial and clearance process.
4. Policy and Advocacy Support
 - Provide technical and organizational support to the Better Nutrition agenda in the Subregional Office for Mesoamerica, particularly on Food Security and Nutrition (FSN), Right to Food, and engagement with parliamentarians and key agrifood system stakeholders.

Expected Outputs

- A systematization report and roadmap for the Dietary Guidelines Community of Practice.
- Draft manuscripts or technical notes for at least two publications.
- A summary brief on activities supporting the Better Nutrition agenda and policy engagement.

Learning Opportunities

- Exposure to FAO's technical work on nutrition, food systems and policy advocacy in Mesoamerica.
- Hands-on experience in knowledge management, technical writing and UN publication processes.
- Development of skills in multi-stakeholder coordination and policy dialogue within the UN system.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

Advanced university degree (Master's or equivalent) in Nutrition, Public Health, Food Systems, Agricultural Sciences, Social Sciences, Economist, or a related field.

Work experience

- One year of relevant experience in areas such as nutrition, food security, food systems, policy analysis, or knowledge management.
- Experience in drafting technical documents, research papers, or communication materials is desirable.

Languages

- Required: Fluency in English, both spoken and written.
- Desirable: Knowledge of Spanish and/or another FAO official language (French, Arabic, Chinese, or Russian).

Other skills

- Proficiency in Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint).
- Familiarity with collaborative platforms (Teams, SharePoint) and virtual meeting tools.
- Basic knowledge of data analysis tools (Excel, SPSS, or similar) is an asset.
- Experience with reference management software (e.g., Zotero, Mendeley) is desirable.

Competencies

- A. Results focus
 - Efficient planning and management of time and resources.
 - Compliance with deadlines and quality standards.
- B. Teamwork
 - Collaboration with technical and administrative teams.
 - Valuing diverse ideas and supporting each other.
- C. Communication
 - Clear and effective writing of reports and publications.
 - Adaptation of the message to different audiences and contexts.

6. Learning Elements

At the end of the assignment the Fellow will be able to:

- Systematize knowledge and lessons learned from regional initiatives and communities of practice (e.g., dietary guidelines) and translate them into actionable recommendations.
- Draft and edit technical reports and manuscripts for publication, applying FAO editorial standards and scientific writing principles.
- Navigate and manage the FAO Publication Workflow System (PWS), understanding the clearance process and quality assurance requirements for UN publications.

- Support policy and advocacy processes related to food security, nutrition, and the Right to Food, including engagement with parliamentarians and multi-stakeholder platforms.
- Apply project coordination skills by assisting in the planning and follow-up of activities within the Better Nutrition agenda in the Subregional Office.
- Enhance communication and teamwork abilities in a multicultural environment, collaborating with technical and administrative teams across the subregion.
- Gain a deeper understanding of FAO's mandate, the Four Betters approach, and regional priorities in Latin America and the Caribbean.

7. Content and methodology of the supervision

- Initial briefing: The Fellow will receive an orientation session covering FAO's mandate, the Subregional Office for Mesoamerica's structure, and the objectives of the Better Nutrition agenda. The supervisor will present the Terms of Reference, expected outputs, and learning objectives.
- Work plan: Within the first week, the fellow will develop a detailed work plan with deliverables, timelines, and milestones.
- Regular supervision:
 - Weekly check-ins (virtual or in person) to review progress, address challenges, and provide technical guidance.
- Feedback and reporting:
 - Continuous feedback will be provided on draft outputs (e.g., manuscripts, reports, knowledge products).
 - The fellow will submit a mid-term progress note and a final report.
- Learning support: The supervisor will facilitate access to relevant FAO resources, communities of practice, and internal webinars to enhance the fellow's technical and professional development.

8. Living conditions in the country

The duty station for this assignment is Panama City, Panama. The city offers good living conditions, with a wide range of housing options and access to health services. Public transportation is available, but most residents use ride-hailing services for convenience. The cost of living is moderate compared to other Latin American capitals, with prices varying depending on the area of residence.

Panama has a tropical climate with high humidity and temperatures averaging 27–30°C throughout the year. The official currency is the Balboa (PAB), which is pegged to the US dollar (USD), and both currencies are used interchangeably. Credit cards are widely accepted.

Security conditions in Panama City are generally stable, but fellows are advised to follow UNDSS security recommendations and avoid high-risk areas. The country offers a vibrant cultural environment.